

Sample Test Plan

A worked IEEE-829-style test plan you can adapt for any project.

How to Use This Sample

This is a completed test plan for a fictional project — the "Acme Online Banking" web application, Release 2.4. Read it to see what "good" looks like, then copy the section headings and replace the example content with your own. It follows the classic IEEE-829 structure that the ISTQB syllabus references.

1. Test Plan Identifier

ACME-OLB-TP-2.4-v1.0. Approved by the Test Manager on 12 March. This identifier is referenced by every defect report and test summary produced for this release.

2. Introduction and Scope

This plan covers system and system-integration testing for Release 2.4, which adds the "Instant Payments" feature and updates the login flow to support two-factor authentication.

In scope	Out of scope
Instant Payments end-to-end flow	Legacy batch-payments engine (unchanged)
Two-factor authentication login	Native mobile apps (separate plan)
Regression of existing transfer features	Non-functional load testing beyond agreed thresholds
Cross-browser testing (Chrome, Edge, Safari)	Internationalisation / localisation

3. Test Approach

Risk-based testing drives prioritisation: payment-handling and authentication carry the highest business risk and receive the deepest coverage. Test design uses equivalence partitioning and boundary value analysis for input fields, and state transition testing for the two-factor login flow. Exploratory sessions supplement scripted tests for the new payments screens.

- Levels: component (developers), integration, system, and acceptance.
- Types: functional, security-focused, and targeted performance checks.
- Automation: regression suite runs in CI on every build; new features are automated after they stabilise.

4. Test Items and Deliverables

Deliverable	Owner	When
Test plan (this document)	Test Manager	Before test execution starts
Test cases and test data	Test Analysts	During test analysis and design
Defect reports	Whole test team	Throughout execution
Test summary report	Test Manager	At end of each test cycle

5. Entry and Exit Criteria

Entry criteria	Exit criteria
Build deployed to the test environment	All planned high-priority test cases executed
Smoke test passes	No open critical or high-severity defects
Test cases reviewed and approved	95% of planned test cases passed
Test data available	Known residual risks accepted by stakeholders

6. Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Payments environment unstable	Medium	Daily smoke test; dedicated support contact
Late delivery squeezes test window	High	Prioritise by risk; agree a reduced-scope fallback
Two-factor codes expire during testing	Low	Use test accounts with extended code validity

7. Schedule and Milestones

1. Week 1 — Test analysis and design; environment ready.
2. Week 2 — Cycle 1 execution (new features).
3. Week 3 — Defect fixes and Cycle 2 (regression).
4. Week 4 — Final regression, exit review, sign-off.

8. Staffing and Responsibilities

- Test Manager — planning, monitoring, control, reporting.
- Two Test Analysts — design and execution.
- One automation engineer — regression suite and CI.

BEST PRACTICE

A test plan is a living document. Revisit the risks and exit criteria at the start of each cycle — if the situation has changed, the plan should change with it, and the change should be visible to stakeholders.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Examiners love the phrase "risk-based testing". When you write or read a test plan, always be able to answer: what is the biggest risk here, and where in the plan is it addressed? That single question ties the whole document together.